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EXOTIC BHUTAN 08 DAYS-EX BAGDOGRA

PHUENTSHOLING 02 NT (1+1) + THIMPHU 02 NT + PUNAKHA 1 NT + PARO 02 NT.

Dear Team

Kuzuzangpo la!!!!(Hello) & Greetings

At the outset we would like to thank you for considering IBD for your upcoming Tour.



The world's only Mahayana Buddhist country. The Buddhist respect for all sentient beings helped Bhutan protects its pristine ecology and wildlife.



- Bhutan, a Buddhist kingdom on the Himalayas' eastern edge, is known for its monasteries, fortresses (or dzongs) and dramatic landscapes that range from subtropical plains to steep mountains and valleys. In the High Himalayas, peaks such as 7,326m Jomolhari are popular trekking destinations. Paro Taktsang monastery (also known as Tiger's Nest) clings to cliffs above the forested Paro Valley.

ITINERARY--08 DAYS BHUTAN TOUR

DAY 01: ARRIVE BAGDOGRA BY AIR & TRANSFER TO PHUENTSHOLING (180 KMS / 05 – 06 HRS DRIVE)

- On arrival at Bagdogra airport, you will be met & transferred to Phuentsholing followed by immigration process.
- Phuentsholing is the gateway to the South, Phuentsholing is a thriving commercial centre on the northern edge of the Indian plains. Situated directly at the base of the Himalayan foothills, it is a fascinating mixture of Indian and Bhutanese, a perfect example of mingling of people and their culture.
- Overnight at the hotel in Phuentsholing



DAY 02: PHUENTSHOLING – THIMPHU (180 KMS / 06 – 07 HRS DRIVE)

- After early breakfast; check out from the hotel & drive to
- On arrival in Thimphu, check into the hotel. The capital town of Bhutan and the centre of Government, religion and commerce, Thimphu is a unique city with unusual mixture of modern development alongside ancient traditions. With the population of about 90,000 it is perhaps still the world's only capital city without a traffic light.

- Afterwards visit to **Buddha Point (Kuensel Phodrang)**. Located at a short drive from Thimphu city centre, visitors can get a good overview of the Thimphu valley from the Buddha point (KuenselPhodrang). You can pay your obeisance and offer prayers to the Buddha, the largest statue in the country and then walk around and take a glimpse of the valley.
- **King's Memorial Chorten** continuously circumambulated by people, murmuring mantras and spinning their prayer wheels. Construction of this landmark was the idea of Bhutan's third king, His Majesty Jigme Dorji Wangchuk ("the father of modern

Bhutan") who has wished to erect monument to world peace and prosperity. Completed in 1974 after his untimely death, it serves both as a memorial to the Late King and as a monument to peace.

- Later visit to **Trashichhoedzong:** This impressive fortress/monastery houses Secretariat building, the throne room of His Majesty, the King and various government offices. It is also the summer residence of Chief Abbot and central monk body.
- Evening an exploratory walk around Thimphu Main Street and market area. Also visit the **Local Crafts Bazaar**, to browse through example of Bhutan's fine traditional arts. Here you can buy hand-woven textiles, Thangkha paintings, masks, ceramics, slate and wood carvings, jewellery, interesting items made from local materials.
- Overnight at the hotel in Thimphu (Altitude 2400m).



DAY 03: **THIMPHU SIGHTSEEING:**

- After breakfast, sightseeing in Thimphu valley including visit to the following: The **National Library**, housing an extensive collection of priceless Buddhist manuscripts; the **Institute for Zorig Chusum** (commonly known as the Painting School) where students undergo a 6-year training course in Bhutan's 13 traditional arts and crafts. Later visit **Textile Museum**, which provides insight into Bhutan's one of the most distinct art form. Also visit **Simply Bhutan,** a living museum and studio encapsulating the cultural heritage of the Bhutanese people.
- After lunch, take a short drive (15 km) to **Pangri Zampa**, 16th century one of the oldest monasteries in Bhutan located just north of Thimphu. Here is a monastic school where Buddhist student's monks learn Lamaism and astrology based on Buddhist philosophy.
- Afternoon visit, **Zilukha Nunnery** is also known as Druthob Goemba. Housing around 60 nuns in its premises, a visit to the site energizes the soul because of its peaceful surroundings, which lures one's mind to never leave the site. This is the biggest nunnery in Bhutan and the interactive session with nuns is very informative. It is a good experience to know about their lifestyle from themselves. Knowing about their experiences, beliefs and education is quite a fun activity.
- Overnight at the hotel in Thimphu



DAY 04: **THIMPHU – PUNAKHA (75 KMS / 03 HRS DRIVE)**

- After breakfast at hotel, drive to Punakha across **Dochula pass (3O8Om).** In Bhutan, the passes are marked by a large Bhutanese Chorten and prayer flag. Dochula pass offers the most spectacular view over the high peaks of the eastern Himalayas on a clear day.
- Enroute proceed for the day excursion to **Chimi Lhakhang** (from hotel it is about 15 minutes' drive till motorable road and then walk starts through paddy fields and villages. This is total about 1½ hour walk, including both way). The Chimi Lhakhang, situated on a hillock in the centre of the valley, also known as the temple of fertility. It is widely believed that couples who do not have children and wanting one, if they pray at this temple, they are usually blessed with a child very soon. The trail leads across rice fields to the tiny settlement of Pana, meaning 'field'. A walk through the village near the temple will give you rare glimpses into the daily life and lifestyle of the villagers.
- After checking into hotel, proceed to visit **Punakha Dzong**, a massive structure built at the junction of two rivers. It was the capital of Bhutan until 1955, and still serves as the winter residence of the monk body.



- Evening can be spent exploring Punakha village located right on the bank of river.
- Overnight at the hotel in Punakha.

DAY 05: PUNAKHA – PARO (120 KMS / 4½ HRS DRIVE APPROX)

- After breakfast, drive to Paro along scenic highway, enroute visit **SimtokhaDzong**, the oldest fortress of the country built in 1627 which now houses the School for Buddhist studies.
- On arrival in Paro, check into the hotel. After lunch, proceed to visit **Ta Dzong**, originally built as Watchtower, which now houses National Museum. The extensive collection includes antique Thangkha paintings, textiles, weapons &armour, household objects and a rich assortment of natural and historic artifacts.
- Ta Dzong visit immediately followed by a short walk down the trail to visit **Rinpung Dzong (ParoDzong)**, meaning ("fortress of the heap of jewels"), which has a long and fascinating history. Along the wooden galleries lining the inner courtyard are fine wall paintings illustrating Buddhist lore such as four friends, the old man of long life, the wheel of life, scenes from the life of Milarepa, Mount. Sumeru and other cosmic Mandala.
- Overnight at the hotel in Paro.



DAY 06: PARO ---TREKING TO TAKSHANG MONASTERY ALSO CALLED TIGER NEST.

- After breakfast excursion to **Taktshang Monastery or Tiger's Nest (approx. 5 hours walk):** It is one of the most famous of Bhutan's monasteries, perched on the side of a cliff 900m above the Paro valley floor. It is said that Guru Rinpoche arrived here on the back of a tigress and meditated at this monastery and hence it is called 'Tiger's Nest'. This site has been recognised as a most sacred place and visited by ShabdrungNgawangNamgyal in 1646 and now visited by all Bhutanese at least once in their lifetime. On 19 April, 1998, a fire severely damaged the main structure of building but now this Bhutanese jewel has been restored to its original splendour.



Or

- **PARO – HAA VALLEY EXCURSION – PARO---@ ADDITIONAL 9800 AS IT IS OUT OF CITY.**
  Start the day early for a full day excursion to Haa via Chele-la pass (3800Mts / 12465Fts, 65 Kms / 02 to 03Hrs – One way) with packed or early breakfast. Visit *Haa Dzong, Lhakhang Karpo, Lhakhang Nagpo, Wangchulo Dzong*. Evening you drive back to Paro. Overnight at the hotel

- Overnight at the hotel in Paro.



DAY 07: PARO – PHUENTSHOLING (170 KMS / 06 – 07 HRS DRIVE)

- After breakfast; check out from the hotel & enjoy the scenic drive to Phuentsholing.
- Upon arrival; check into the hotel. The gateway to the south, Phuentsholing is a thriving commercial centre on the northern edge of the Indian plains. Situated directly at the base of the Himalayan foothills, it is a fascinating mixture of Indian and Bhutanese, a perfect example of mingling of people and their culture.
- Overnight at the hotel in Phuentsholing



DAY 08: PHUENTSHOLING – BAGDOGRA (180 KMS / 05 – 06 HRS DRIVE).

- Breakfast at the hotel followed by the immigration clearance, you will be dropped at Bagdogra airport to board your flight for onward journey.

COSTING FOR COUPLE.
4-star standard INR 185800 for couple 4-star premium INR 199000 for couple

- 5 star = INR 248500 for couple
  IF will do Haa vally then 9800 will be extra as mentioned above

HOTELS/SIMILAR

CITIES	NT	4 STAR STANDARD	4 STAR PREMIUM	5 STAR	MEAL PLAN
Phuentsholing	2	Tashi Namgyel 4* /Druk 3 * Premium	Tashi Namgyel 4* / Druk 3* Premium	Tashi Namgyel 4* / Druk 3* Premium	Breakfast + Dinner
Thimphu	2	Ariya	Turma Linca	Le Méridien Thimphu 5*	Breakfast + Dinner
Punakha	1	Spirit Village Lodge	Spirit Village Lodge	Spirit Village Lodge	Breakfast + Dinner
Paro	2	Thim Dorji	Kaachi Grand	Le Méridien Paro, Riverfront 5*	Breakfast + Dinner

INCLUDED

- 07 night accommodation on double sharing basis.
- Tourist permit for Bhutan.
- SUV within Bhutan , Electric BYD or MG or similar
- Pick up/drop from Bagdogra Airport in Breeza or Dezire
- Daily 2 meals (Breakfast & Dinner) at hotel.
- A qualified & Licensed English-speaking guide
- **Sustainable Development Fee (SDF) for permit**
- All sightseeing as per tour plan.
- 02 Bottled per day mineral water at the start of the tour
- Full service & assistance before, during and after you Bhutan trip.
- GST

EXCLUDED

- Lunch, approx. 800
- Any beverages (hot or cold ordered during Breakfast, lunch or dinner)
- Any other cost arising due to medical situations, political unrest or any weather-related conditions beyond our control
- Expenditure of personal nature
- Phuentsholing Pedestrian Terminal entry fee (Rs.10/- pp)—to be paid at the point of entry on day 1.
- Monuments and scared sites entrance fee.Approx 1000 to 4000 depending upon no of visits during whole tour.
- Tips for the guide and driver
- Travel Insurance (Not Compulsory)

Facts and Figures

- Land area : 38,394 square kilo metres
- Forest area : 72.5 %
- Altitude : between 240metres and 7541metres above sea level
- Inhabitants : 700,000
- Language : official language “Dzongkha”, English & Hindi widely spoken.
- Religion : Vajrayana stream of Mahayana Buddhism (Also known as Tantric Buddhism)
- Currency : Ngultrum (equal to Indian Rupee)
- Capital : Thimphu
- National Tree : Cypress
- National Bird : Raven
- National Flower : Blue Poppy
- National Sport : Archery

- National Animal : Takin
- Local time : Six hours ahead of GMT and half an hour ahead of Indian Standard Time

Few Local words you can learn for local connect.

- You are welcome **Jembalaekso**
- Hello (formal) **Kuzu zangpo la**
- Hello (informal) **Kuzu zangpo**
- Nice to meet you **Nga choe da chebay sem ga yi**
- How are you? **Gaday bay Zhui?**
- I'm fine. **Legshom (Layshom)**
- What is your name? **Chhoe gi ming ga chi mo?**
- Thank You: **Ka din chey la**
- Good bye/wishes **Tashi Delek**
- Water: **Chhu**
- You: **Choe**
- Nga: **Me**
- Lets go: **Jo gay**
- See you later! **Tama che gae**
- See you tomorrow **Naba che gae**
- No problem **Khe mi**
- Sorry **Tsip maza/ Gom mathrae**
- Excuse me **Atsi zur nang**
- How much? **Ga day chi mo?**
- Meal- **Toh /zhay go**
- Delicious **Zhim bay**

Documents for permit approval:

- Very Clear passport size photo (soft copy)
- Very Clear copy of ID –Voter Card or 06 months valid passport.(any one)
- For children below 18 --Birth certificate (WITH NAME OF CHILD) or passport. (any one)
- Original document to be carried at the time of travelling.
- Aadhar card not accepted in Bhutan.
- Note—on arrival permit is also possible but it is suggested to take permit before travel to avoid the long process at immigration.

KA DIN CHEY LA

(THANK YOU)